

DIVISION I

Hand them a title

Saints' defense stifles Westlake

Kevin Aprile
The Chronicle-Telegram

GRAFTON — Southview might have been the hands-down favorite in Saturday's Division I sectional final against Westlake, but the second-seeded Saints didn't start showing their superiority until they got their hands up.

"One thing we talked about at halftime was getting a hand on the ball any time it's exposed," Southview coach Brian Koury said after his team's relentless pressure defense finally wore down the Demons in a 61-50 win at Midview High School.

Southview improved to 16-5 with their seventh win in their last eight games and moves on to face Olmsted Falls in the district semifinal on Thursday at 7 p.m. Westlake ended its season at 7-15.

Westlake caused Southview all manner of fits in the first half thanks to its Princeton-like spread-the-floor-and-slow-it-down attack. The Demons opened an 18-13 lead after the first quarter and had it to 25-17 with 5:14 to play in the first half.

It was a scrappy performance by the Demons, who used their quickness and ballhandling skills to find open cutters for easy baskets. On top of that, they were perfect from the foul line to that point and hitting clutch 3-pointers.

"Westlake took us out of our game plan the first half," Koury conceded. "They really exposed our pressure with their backdoor cutters."

But the Demons couldn't stand prosperity, turning the ball over on six of their final nine possessions of the half. They didn't score again, in fact,



JASON MILLER / CHRONICLE

Southview's Brian Remaklus (top) goes after the ball while Westlake's Steve Barrett tries to haul it in during the Saints' 61-50 victory over the Demons on Saturday night in a Division I sectional championship game at Midview High School.

until Brett Henderson hit a pair of free throws with no time on the clock.

That sent Westlake into halftime with the lead at 27-25, but without the momentum.

"I thought the kids executed the game plan the first half," Westlake coach Art Daniels said. "We stressed being patient all week, but we had a few unforced turnovers in the second quarter."

The forced turnovers came in the third quarter.

In waves.

Suddenly the Saints were everywhere, swarming Westlake's ballhandlers and leaving them little room to breathe. Led by senior guard Brian Remaklus, who unofficially tied his career high with 10 steals, the Saints forced the Demons into turnovers on eight of their first 10 possessions.

When Ray Jackson, who led

Southview with 16 points and four blocked shots, hit two free throws a minute and a half into the third quarter, the Saints had their first lead (29-27) since going up 7-5.

Westlake was still within reach at quarter's end, down 42-37, but turnovers on three of their first five possessions of the fourth allowed Southview to open a 50-39 lead and pretty much put the game on ice.

"We've seen them do that before," Daniels said of the Saints. "In the third quarter they got a little tighter (on defense) and their traps got a little closer. We told the kids what to expect. Of course, you can expect it all you want, but going out and executing it is a different story."

"After halftime we really picked up the intensity on defense and that really helped out on the offensive end as

well," said Remaklus, who scored 10 points.

Adriene Rodriguez, who also scored 10 points, hurt Westlake the most with his penetration and ability to find open teammates. Maurice Johnson added 11 points.

Henderson led Westlake with 16 points and six rebounds, while Alex Buskey added 15 points.

"I think we got a little tired," Daniels said. "It wears on you trying to battle (Southview's) pressure and their size all game long."

In other words, he had to hand it to the Saints.

SOUTHVIEW (61): Rodriguez 4, 2-10, Remaklus 4-1-10, Bennett 2-7, Johnson 4-5-11, Jackson 5-5-15, Williams 1-3-5, Quattabum 1-1-3. Totals 21-17-61.
WESTLAKE (50): Henderson 4-8-16, McAllister 1-0-2, Buskey 4-4-15, Turk 3-0-7, Schubert 2-0-4, McCullum 2-0-4, Barnett 0-0-0, Reid 1-0-2, Milan 0-0-0. Totals 17-12-50.
Southview: 13 12 17 19 — 61
Westlake: 18 9 10 13 — 50
Three-pointers: Southview 2 (Bennett, Remaklus), Westlake 4 (Buskey 2, Turk, Buskey).
Rebounds: Southview 13, Westlake 22.
Turnovers: Southview 12, Westlake 27.

'Dogs grind out a victory

Roger Neglin
The Chronicle-Telegram

GRAFTON — Basketball fans who sat in on the instant classic that Southview and Olmsted Falls fashioned here last season are eagerly awaiting an instant replay.

It could happen Thursday night when the Saints and Bulldogs square off in the Division I district semifinals at Midview.

Olmsted Falls might lack the flamboyance and scoring ability of last year's district title team, but don't underrate the Bulldogs' tenacity and resourcefulness.

Both traits were evident in a 38-34 grind-it-out victory over Brunswick in the sectional finals Saturday night. Olmsted Falls (17-5), the tournament's No. 4 seed, advanced with victories over a pair of sectional teams that have 30 wins between them.

Brunswick (16-6) had won eight games in a row.

On Thursday, the teams will take the court in reversed roles. Last year the Saints were unseeded while the Bulldogs were the top seed, but the Saints took the game into overtime before losing. This year Southview is seeded No. 2.

"I'm looking forward to it," said Olmsted Falls coach Pat Donahue. "Our kids are looking forward to it and I'm sure Southview is too. It's a game a lot of people wanted to see and they'll get their wish."

"I just hope we come out and keep it respectable. They've got a tough team and we've got our work cut out for us."

Defense has been the hallmark of the Bulldogs' two sectional victories. On Saturday, they held the Blue Devils to two points in the second quarter and 21 total points in the last 24 minutes. Brunswick went more than nine minutes with only two points.

Meanwhile, Falls ran off 14 straight points in a 2½-minute span of the second quarter.

Tyler Sparks scored inside, Cory Emerine sank a 3-point shot. Nate Portik scored in the lane off an Emerine steal, Pat Braddick canned a 3-pointer, Corey Sparks scored inside and then Braddick finished it off with another bucket.

The Bulldogs turned a 15-6 deficit into a 20-15 halftime lead.

"That's been one of our signatures over the last 10 years," Donahue said. "This year's team hasn't done it as much, but we're capable. That's the best we've had all year."

"That one stretch cost us," said Brunswick coach Joe Mackey. "We got a little lazy with passes and they converted off turnovers, but we came back. We just couldn't put a string of two or three possessions together."

"We've been rock solid on defense all season long, but our problem was that we couldn't score. That's been a problem all year, but it's tough to say anything negative about these kids. They didn't quit on us when they lost four in a row and then won eight straight. And they didn't quit at the end."

After scoring only two points in the second quarter, Brunswick held Olmsted Falls to four in the third and took a 25-24 lead into the fourth.

"We have to get rid of these crummy quarters," Donahue said.

The Bulldogs were able to withstand two more Brunswick 3-pointers in the final minute, as Portik and Emerine each made two free throws and Braddick scored on a long inbounds pass with eight seconds remaining.

BRUNSWICK (34): Wes Bonick 0-0-0, Kevin Henry 3-1-7, Ryan Montgomery 2-1-5, Brandon Scott 3-0-8, Travis Lamm 4-2-11, Sean Kelly 1-0-3, Ed Ritchie 0-0-0. Totals 13-4-34.
OLMSTED FALLS (38): Tyler Sparks 2-7-7, Nate Portik 1-2-4, Corey Sparks 3-0-6, Cory Emerine 2-2-8, Pat Braddick 4-0-9, Dave Pelletie 1-0-2, Scott Arcin 0-0-0, A.J. Sedley 1-0-2. Totals 14-7-38.
Brunswick: 13 2 10 9 — 34
Olmsted Falls: 8 14 4 14 — 38
Three-point goals: Olmsted Falls (3) Brad-dick, Emerine 2, Brunswick (4-19) Scott 2, Lamm, Kelly, Rebovich; Olmsted Falls 23 (C Sparks 6, Brunswick 31) Montgomery 10.
Turnovers: Olmsted Falls 12, Brunswick 13.
Total fouls: Olmsted Falls 10, Brunswick 13.

DIVISION II

'Cats survive Warrior attack

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

OLMSTED FALLS — Survival is the name of the game once the high-school basketball postseason tournament arrives.

Survive is exactly what Keystone did Saturday night against Fairview in a Olmsted Falls Division II sectional championship.

The second-seeded Wildcats escaped with their tournament lives, 54-49, to advance to Wednesday's district semifinal against Padua, a 56-49 upset winner over No. 3 Rocky River in Saturday's opener.

"I don't bite my nails but I was pulling my hair out a couple times there," said Keystone coach Greg Morgan. "It got a little nail-biting at the end, I guess."

The Wildcats had things well in hand, 48-40, following a pair of Todd Schlenkerman free throws with just under three minutes to play.

But Jason Moore picked up his fifth foul a minute later, starting a chain of events that breathed new life into the Warriors' hopes.

"It wasn't so much (Fairview) taking the ball from us," said Morgan. "It was us not catching the ball. One time we threw it right back to the guy standing out of bounds."

Three times Keystone tried to inbound the basketball after Fairview scores and three times it turned it over — including the one Morgan described where Aaron Lindstrom threw the inbounds pass only to have it returned to him before he crossed the baseline.

Fairview scored six unanswered points and, following a pair of Wildcats free throws, closed to within 50-49 on a 3-pointer by Steve Manos with 35 seconds remaining.

A five-second violation on another inbounds attempt led to the usually reliable Mike Stanton at the line with a chance to give Fairview the lead with 29 seconds left. But Stanton failed to sink either free-throw attempt.

"Mike's been with me for three years — a three-year starter," said Fairview coach Eric Smith. "If you'd ask me who I'd want at the free-throw line, he's it. The first one's in-and-out. What are you going to do?"

The Wildcats won without a fourth-quarter field goal but managed to maintain the lead thanks to 12-of-16 free-throw shooting.

"They stuck their free throws down the stretch," said Smith.

"We pull it out just to open it up," Morgan said of the patient, spread offense Keystone ran in the final minutes. "We want to be more patient when we have the lead because we do handle (the ball) well. (Fairview) eventually will gamble and they did and we got free throws out of it."

John Hrnchar and Lindstrom put the game away with four straight free throws in the final 18 seconds. Keystone's back-court threesome of Schlenkerman, Lindstrom and Joe Bailosky combined to sink 12 free throws in 13 tries.

All three wound up in double figures led by Schlenkerman's 14 points and seven rebounds.

"Our guards are definitely our advantage as far as handling the ball," Morgan said. "We were on the verge of blowing the game open if we'd just hit a couple shots. Getting a (tournament) game under our belt was important."

"It was a great effort," said Smith. "It came up a little bit short. All you can do is ask for a chance. That's what we battled for. We had a chance at the end."

"It was a win," Morgan said. "We'll learn from it."

KEYSTONE (54): Aaron Lindstrom 3-5-12, Joe Bailosky 3-2-11, Todd Schlenkerman 4-5-14, John Hrnchar 2-2-6, Jason Moore 2-2-5, Craig Savage 1-0-2, Steve Padua 0-1-1. Totals 18-17-54.
FAIRVIEW (49): Mike Rieck 1-1-3, Kevin Fanning 2-1-5, Mike Stanton 3-0-4, Steve Manos 3-0-12, Jimmy Kempton 2-2-2, Dan Schlenker 2-3-7, Matt Kury 4-5-13, Brett Berg 0-0-0. Totals 17-12-49.
Keystone: 15 16 11 12 — 54
Fairview: 10 11 13 15 — 49
Three-point goals: Keystone 5-15, Bailosky 3, Lindstrom, Schlenkerman, Fanning 3-13, Manos 3, Rebovich, Kempton 2, Schlenkerman 7, Fanning 37, Manos 24, Stanton 7, Turnovers: Keystone 12, Fairview 25. Total fouls: Keystone 15, Fairview 24. Fouled out: Moore, Stanton.

DIVISION III

'Horns grab 'surprise' victory

Hans Schneider
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — Going into the Division III sectional championship Saturday night at Elyria High School, Woodridge coach Matt Giovanini knew he was going to have his hands full with Richard Semrau and Greg Andrews.

His Bulldogs did a good job in the first half of limiting the duo to six points. However, there were a few things that Giovanini didn't expect.

Like Sam Morrison and Stephen Argento picking up the slack with 12 points and 10 points, respectively, in the first half.

Or Lutheran West shooting 10-of-10 from the field in the third quarter.

Or Semrau flirting with a triple-double as the 6-foot-10 junior finished with 16 points, 11 rebounds and nine blocks.

Well, maybe that last one wasn't a total surprise as Lutheran West held off a feisty Woodridge team 71-56 to

advance to the district semifinal game against Clearview on Tuesday night. Clearview knocked off Oberlin 39-33 in the early game.

"We were right there in the second quarter," said Giovanini. "Our guys did a nice job of taking Semrau and Andrews out of the flow of the offense."

"But Morrison and Argento hit some shots that caught us off guard."

Lutheran West (21-0) led 16-10 after the first quarter and led 20-12 before a 3-pointer by Morrison and an Argento basket upped the lead to 25-15 with 3:54 left in the half.

Woodridge (8-13) came charging back as Mylan Murphy's second 3-pointer of the quarter and a Kori Korinek basket cut the Lutheran West lead to 25-20 with 1:54 remaining.

A pair of free throws by Scott Blackburn stopped the Bulldogs' run and the Lutheran West defense kicked it into gear — forcing three turnovers that turned into seven Longhorn

points. Lutheran West led 34-20 at halftime.

However, Lutheran West was just warming up.

The Longhorns came out firing in the third quarter, hitting all of their shots, including a pair of 3-pointers as they extended their lead to 53-39.

After hitting only two of his first seven shots, Semrau hit four straight for nine points to lead the Longhorns charge.

"We made some adjustments at halftime," said Semrau. "It allowed me to get some different looks at the basket that I didn't get in the first half."

Woodridge made another small run at the Longhorns in the fourth quarter, cutting the deficit to 62-49 with 6:23 left.

However, Lutheran West scored nine unanswered points, ending any legitimate chance by Woodridge to pull off the upset.

"The game was played in spurts," said Lutheran West coach Phil Argento. "They had some nice spurts on us early,

but we had the last one in the fourth quarter that ran the lead to 22 points. Richard took advantage of some situations in the third quarter that opened up things on offense for the entire team."

"I give Woodridge a lot of credit. Their coach did a nice job preparing his team and it worked to their advantage in the first half."

Morrison led Lutheran West with 20 points and Argento finished with 12.

Leading Woodridge were Murphy (16 points), Tyler Eischen (14 points) and Josh Owens (10 points).

WOODRIDGE (56): Mylan Murphy 6-1-16, Tyler Eischen 4-4-14, Josh Owens 3-2-10, Kori Korinek 4-1-9, Greg Mikosinc 2-0-5, Brent Borgardt 1-0-2, Totals 20-4-56.
LUTHERAN WEST (71): Sam Morrison 8-2-20, Richard Semrau 7-1-16, Stephen Argento 5-0-12, David Bailey 4-1-9, Scott Blackburn 1-4-6, Greg Andrews 2-0-4, Derek Voytovich 1-2-4. Totals 28-9-71.
Woodridge: 10 10 19 17 — 56
Lutheran West: 16 18 24 13 — 71
Field goals: Woodridge 20-55; Lutheran West 28-56. **Three-pointers:** Woodridge 8-19 (Murphy 3, Eischen 2, Blackburn); Lutheran West 8-19 (Murphy 3, Eischen 2, Owens 2, Mikosinc). **Free throws:** Woodridge 8-22; Lutheran West 9-10. **Rebounds:** Woodridge 28 (Korinek 6); Lutheran West 40 (Semrau 11). **Turnovers:** Woodridge 10, Lutheran West 14. **Fouls:** Woodridge 10, Lutheran West 17. **Fouled out:** None.

DIVISION IV

Lutheran East outlasts Open Door

Jerry Henson
The Chronicle-Telegram

STRONGSVILLE — To quote an old cliché: When the going gets tough, the tough get going.

Third-seeded Lutheran East adhered to that cliché Saturday night as the Falcons struggled to a 50-45 victory over Open Door in a Division IV sectional championship game.

With the win, the Falcons carry a 16-5 record into the district semifinals Tuesday night. The Patriots finish their season with an 11-11 record.

"We intensified our defense and stepped things up at the end," said Lutheran East coach Roger McClinton. "This was one of those methodical Division IV games. We adjusted to Open Door's defense and took advantage of what they gave us. We also made some key free throws at the end."

After the Patriots led 26-22 at halftime and the teams

"We've accomplished an awful lot this season since being soundly beaten (84-38) by Firelands in our opener. We'll be fine as we play a tough schedule."

Alan Januzzi,
Open Door basketball coach

exchanged baskets in the first 4½ minutes of the third quarter. Jon Liggins knocked down a pair of 3-pointers to help swing the momentum the Falcons' way.

A 6-0 Falcons run gave them a 44-38 lead with 2:06 left to play. Open Door's Matt Carratola nailed a 3-pointer and Ryan Young and Jared Herron hit baskets to neutralize Lutheran East baskets and keep the lead at three. Herron's basket came with :30 left, making it a 48-45 game before Brandon Butler made two free throws eight seconds later for the final out-

come. "Lutheran East obviously is more talented," said Patriots coach Alan Januzzi. "They upped their pressure on us and executed when they needed to. We did the right things and wouldn't have changed anything. We were ready but knew that things have to fall in place. You also need to have some luck. For us to compete this well with them really says a lot. We executed our game plan and couldn't ask for anything more."

"We've accomplished an awful lot this season since being soundly beaten (84-38) by

Firelands in our opener. We'll be fine as we play a tough schedule."

The Patriots broke away from an early 5-4 deficit by scoring seven unanswered points. Liggins' 3-pointer with 6:12 left in the first half put the Falcons on top, 16-13.

Two Matt Carratola free throws and Ryan Young's three-point play swung the pendulum back to Open Door. From there, the teams exchanged scores until Lutheran East's John Shannon tied it at 22 with 2:08 left. Carratola broke the tie at 1:26 and Herron's basket with three seconds left gave the Patriots a 25-22 lead at halftime.

LUTHERAN EAST (50): Brian 4-2-10, S. Liggins 4-0-8, J. Liggins 5-3-13, Derron 1-1-3, McClinton 3-0-6, Shannon 2-0-4. Totals 20-4-50.
OPEN DOOR (45): Carratola 3-2-9, Young 4-3-11, Herron 3-2-9, Freeman 0-0-0, Ben 2-0-15. Totals 18-15-45.
Lutheran East: 9 13 10 18 — 50
Open Door: 13 13 6 13 — 45
Three-point goals: Lutheran East 4 (J. Liggins 4), Open Door 2 (Carratola 1, J. Liggins 1).